



from the curves exhibited by the Endeavour and Fortuner. With the SUV market being one of the most popular in India, Skoda's new luxury offering has every potential to be one of the most interesting prospects here. Whether it will fulfil that expectation or not is something we can only tell once it is launched for the general public.

Range Rover Velar

Falling in between the Range Rover Evoque and Sport in terms of pricing, the new Range Rover Velar is expected to enter India some time around Q3 2017. It is expected to be made available in India with five variants - three with petrol engines and two with diesel. The peak variant is expected to produce impressive figures of 296 brake horsepowers of power and 700Nm of torque.

Inside, it is expected to house Land Rover's custom InControl infotainment suite, along with some of the intuitive features that we have already seen in the new Land Rover



Discovery lineup. The new SUV is expected to offer all the luxuries, and will be built completely in our very own JLR's manufacturing plant in the United Kingdom.

This essentially means that the Range Rover Velar will be a completely built unit imported to India, and as such, is expected to open pricing at somewhere between ₹45 to 50 lac. with further variants priced higher.

Volvo XC60

The Volvo XC60 is only one of the most popular mid-sized SUVs across the world, and a much-due facelift along with a new infotainment package makes for yet another promising entrant in the luxury SUV segment.

Interestingly, the Volvo XC60 will be a direct competitor to the Range Rover Velar, alongside the Porsche Macan, Jaguar



F-Pace and others. Volvo has taken a number of cues from the bigger XC90, all of which is evident in the design. The rear still remains immediately recognisable as a Volvo, and its new infotainment unit is well-stocked in face of its tech-laden competition in the market.

Technological advancements on the new XC60 continue with the drivetrain as well, with a T8 Twin Engine plug-in hybrid engine that produces 401bhp, which takes the car from 0-100kph in 5.3 seconds. With the luxury SUV competition ramping up in India, it remains to be seen how the XC60 fares against its competition.

Jeep Compass

The Compass is expected to be a more affordable Jeep SUV, after the Wrangler and Grand Cherokee were introduced in India as completely built units. The Jeep Compass will join India's SUV portfolio alongside the Skoda Kodiaq, and will be built in Fiat Chrysler's Ranjangaon plant in India.



To go with its all-terrain stance, the Jeep Compass is expected to present all-wheel drive, and is internationally available in both petrol and diesel trims. It is not clear yet as to which variants will come to India, but there is a possibility that Jeep introduces only the diesel variant here.

The category it will fall in will be a more competitive one than the luxury segment, and Jeep will be up against already established companies such as Toyota and Ford, who maintain a stronghold in this segment. It will be interesting to see how Jeep ends up faring with its first competitive launch in the country.

All of these launches promise an exciting season ahead for automobiles in India. Whether you're looking out for a hatchback, an SUV or a notchback, there is something for every gearhead out there. 